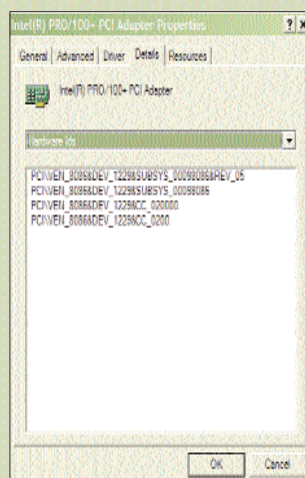




Get extra information about system devices

drive, and so on until 26 for drive Z. If you need to hide more than one drive, add the respective drive numbers and enter it into the value data field. For example, to hide drive C you need to enter 4 (2^{3-1}); to hide drives D and E you need to enter 24 ($2^{4-1} + 2^{5-1}$). To apply the change to all users in the system, follow the same method, but use the key **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer** instead. To remove all restrictions, just delete the entry.

■ Know your real writing speed in Nero

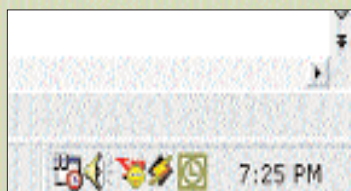
While writing a CD using Nero 5.5, only the average speed is displayed in the burn status dialog box. To force Nero to display the actual writing speed, navigate to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Ahead\Nero-BurningRom\Recorder**. Under this, open the DWORD entry 'ShowSingleRecorderSpeed' (create one if it doesn't exist). Change the value of this entry to '1' to display the actual writing speed, and '0' to display the average writing speed.

OFFICE



■ Minimise Outlook to the system tray

Outlook 2003 can be minimised to the system tray, but it's possible with earlier versions of Outlook as well. Go to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Office\10.0\Outlook\Preferences** and create



You can minimise Outlook XP to the system tray

a DWORD entry named 'MinToTray'. Give it a value of '1'. Restart Outlook for the change to take effect.

■ Give four digits for year in Excel

Whenever a date is entered in an Excel cell, the year field is automatically truncated to two digits. For example, when the user enters the date 9-11-2000 in a cell, it is automatically replaced with 9/11/00. This is bad when spanning across a century, such as records from 1999 to 2003. This tweak makes Excel display dates with four digits for the year field. Locate **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Office\10.0\Excel\Options**, where [Version] indicates your Office version (Office XP is

'10.0', 2000 is '9.0', etc.). Create or modify the DWORD entry 'EnableFourDigitYearDisplay' and enter a value of '1'.

■ Change the number of undo levels in Excel

By default, Excel can perform 16 undo operations. You can customise the number of undo levels, but remember that increasing the number of levels results in more RAM being allocated to Excel.

Go to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Office\10.0\Excel\Options**. Under this key, create a DWORD value with the name 'UndoHistory'. You can turn off the undo feature by giving a value of '0', use the maximum allowed level '100', or provide an intermediate level of your choice. Remember to select the decimal radio button when entering a value between 0 and 100.

■ Remove attachments restrictions

When an incoming e-mail has attachments such as EXE, SCR, etc., Outlook XP doesn't download the attachments, for security reasons. The complete list of file extensions which aren't downloaded in Outlook XP and 2003 is: ADE, ADP, ASX, BAS, BAT, CHM, CMD, COM,